Tangut Tibetan Transcription Scheme

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This scheme spells Tangut in Tibetan script. It is based on Gong Xun's reconstruction and aims at simple, natural Tibetan orthography. The scheme is recreational.

1 Initials

Labial		Dental		Alveolar		Palatal		Retroflex		Velar		Uvular		Laryngeal	
p	པ	*t*	ཏ	*ts*	ཙ	*tś*	ཅ	*tṣ*	(ཅ)	*k*	ཀ	*q*	(ཀ)	Ø	ཨ
ph	ཕ	*th*	ཐ	*tsh*	ཚ	*tśh*	ཆ	*tṣh*	(ཆ)	*kh*	ཁ	*qh*	(ཁ)		
b	བ	*d*	ད	*dz*	ཛ	*dź*	ཇ	*dẓ*	(ཇ)	*g*	ག	*ġ*	(ག)		
f	ཕ༹	*lh*	ཐ༹	*s*	ས	*ś*	ཤ	*ṣ*	(ཤ)	*h*	ཧ	*h*	ཧ		
		ll	ད༹	*z*	ཟ	*ź*	ཞ	*ẓ*	(ཞ)	*gh*	ག༹	*ġh*	(ག༹)		
v	བ༹	*l*	ལ			*y*	ཡ	*r*	ར					*w*	ཨྭ
m	མ	*n*	ན					*ṇ*	ཎ			*ŋ*	ང		

The scheme does not distinguish the *tś*/*tṣ* or *k*/*q* initial sets. The latter are conditioned uvularized allophones and remain recoverable from the rhyme grade.

2 Vowels

	a		**e**		**i**		**o**		**u**		**ə**	
Grade III	*a*	ཨ	*e*	ཨེ	*i*	ཨི	*o*	ཨོ	*u*	ཨུ	*ə*	ཨྀ
Grade I	*a̱*	ཨའ	*e̱*	ཨའེ	*i̱*	ཨའི	*o̱*	ཨའོ	*u̱*	ཨའུ	*ə̱*	ཨའྀ
Grade II	*aa̱*	ཨཨ	*ae̱*	ཨཨེ	*ai̱*	ཨཨི	*ao̱*	ཨཨོ	*au̱*	ཨཨུ	*aə̱*	ཨཨྀ
Grade IV	*a*	ཨཡ	*e*	ཨཡེ	*i*	ཨཡི	—	—	*u*	ཨཡུ	*ə*	ཨཡྀ

The scheme marks Grades I, II, III, and IV respectively with postposed འ, postposed ཨ, zero, and postposed ཡ. Grade IV comprises R.3, R.11, R.20, R.31, R.37, and R.47. This notation preserves the rhyme books' categorical distinctions: even if Grade IV was probably separated artificially, the scheme still marks it.

3 Non-systemic marks and tones

GX	Tibetan	Category
?	postposed ?	uncertain tone
†	postposed †	other uncertainty (reading evidence, onset, etc.)
^{1}	unmarked	level tone
^{2}	postposed ས	rising tone

4 Segmental features

GX	Tibetan	Category
n-, *m-*, *ŋ-*	preposed འ	nasal preinitial
-w-	subjoined ཝ	labial medial
-a-	ཨ	Grade-II medial
-y-	subjoined ཡ	palatal medial
v-, *y-*, *r-*	◌ྺ, ◌ྻ, ◌ྼ	fixed forms when actual initials are forced below a superscript
-w	postposed ག	velar coda
-ṃ	postposed མ	nasal coda

GX *vw* is the conditioned Grade-I/II realization after *v*, and its *w* is not written separately. When *v/y/r* are actual initial bases forced below a superscript in a stack, they use fixed forms ◌ྺ/◌ྻ/◌ྼ; genuine added *w/y* remain ordinary ◌ྭ/◌ྱ. Although based on GX, the scheme also reflects rhyme-table categories: GX merges R.92/R.100 and R.79/R.101, but preposed འ in R.100 and R.101 preserves the rhyme books' distinction.

5 Syllable-wide suprasegmental features

GX	Tibetan	Category
-h	superscribed ས	tense vowel
r-...-r	superscribed ར	retroflex vowel

In *rVr* (and similar) forms, the two occurrences of *r* represent one *r* initial restricted to retroflex rhymes. Thus *rur*[1], *rer*[1], *rir*[1], *rar*[1] are written རུ, རེ, རི, ར. Zero onset in the rhyme inventory is only a placeholder for displaying a rhyme and does not belong to this type.

6 Spelling tests

6.1 Word tests

Tangut	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]
GX	*nye*¹	*phu*²	*dźə?*	*świ*¹	*ba̱a*¹	*śeṃ*¹	*li̱w*¹	*śih*²	*hae̱ṃ*²	*ġhai̱h*²	*rŋo̱ṃr*²	*llo̱ṃh*²	*rġhwe̱r*²
Tibetan	འཆྱེ	ཕྱུས	ཛེ?†	ཤྭི	བཞ	ཤེམ	ལའིག	ཤྲིས	ཧཨེམས	སྒཨིས	ཛའོམས	སྡའོམས	སྒྭའེས

6.2 Sentence tests

Tangut	**GX**	**Tibetan**
[illegible]，	*mə̱*¹ *lləh*² *rur*¹ *qae̱h*² *ne*²,	མའི་སྦྱོས་རུ་སྐྲཨེས་ནཡེས།
[illegible]。	*bi̱*² *lhih*² *tśhə*¹ *zoh*² *śa*².	བའིས་སྦྲིས་ཚི་སྦྲོས་ཤྲས།།
[illegible]，	*swi̱w*¹ *na̱*¹ *ẓaə̱h*¹ *rtṣai̱r*¹ *dẓae̱*²,	སྭའིག་ནའ་སྣཨོ་རྩཨི་ཛཨེས།
[illegible]。	*tsa*¹ *da̱h*² *phu*² *bi*² *ŋwe̱*².	ཙཡ་སྦྱའས་ཕྱུས་བཡིས་ངའེས།།

6.3 Paragraph test

Tangut	[illegible]

GX	*dze^{2} ryər^{1}: tha̱^{1} da̱h^{2}: "rtser^{2} le^{2} tha̱^{1} śeṃ^{1}" yə^{2} ta^{1} thə^{2} vwo̱^{2} the^{2} so^{2}? ndze^{2} da̱h^{2}: rmə̱r^{2} rtser^{2} swi̱w^{1} nwi^{2} ta^{1}, le^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rmə̱r^{2} rtser^{2} le^{2} nwi^{2}, le^{2} du^{1} lli̱w^{2} me^{1} ta^{1}, swi̱w^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}. swi̱w^{1} rmə̱r^{2} tha^{1} śe^{1}, yuo^{1} dźeh^{1} mi^{1} si^{1} ta^{1}, rtser^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. thə^{2} su^{2} rtser^{2} le^{2} ye^{1} tha̱^{1} śeṃ^{1} yə^{2} lə^{1}. nuo^{1} ryər^{1}: nvwi̱^{1} ndźe^{1} do̱^{2} rdzar^{2} rllər^{1} ye^{1} vwo̱^{2} ta^{1}, lləh^{1} kə^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}? ndze^{2} da̱h^{2}: a^{1} rlər^{2} le^{2} nwi^{2}, qu̱^{1} nvwi̱^{1} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}; le^{2} dźo? le^{2} rər^{2} nə^{2} tha̱^{1} śeṃ^{1} ta^{1}, ndźe^{1} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rqwə̱r^{1} le^{2} rtser^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rtser^{2} ta^{1} tśa^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}; tśa^{1} ta^{1} yuo^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}; yuo^{1} ta^{1} tha̱^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}. thə^{2} ta^{1} do̱^{2} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rtser^{2} le^{2} rmə̱r^{2} si^{2} ŋa̱^{1} me^{1}, le^{2} lli̱w^{2} mi^{1} du^{1}, le^{2} ye^{1} le^{2} me^{1}, tśhow^{1} rdzar^{2} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. ryər^{1} rmer^{2} thə^{2} bi̱h^{2} ghiw^{1} ġhwae̱^{1} dzu^{1} yu^{2}.*
Tibetan	ཛཡེས་རྐྱི། ཐའ་སྡའས། འརྩེས་ལཡེས་ཐའ་ཤེམ་ཡཡོས་ཏཡ་ཐཡོས་ཕྲོས་ཐཡེས་སོས།། འཛོས་སྡའས། རྨའེས་འརྩེས་སྭའེག་ནྭཡིས་ཏཡ། ལཡེས་ངའུས།། རྨའེས་འརྩེས་ལཡེས་ནྭཡིས། ལཡེས་དཡུ་དའེགས་མཡེ་ཏཡ། སྭའེག་ངའུས།། སྭའེག་རྨའེས་ཐཡ་ཤེ། ཡོུ་སྡེ་མཡི་སཡི་ཏཡ། འརྩེས་ངའུས།། ཐཡོས་སཡུས་འརྩེས་ལཡེས་ཡཡེ་ཐའ་ཤེམ་ཡཡོས་ལཡོ།། ཉྭུ་རྐྱི། འཕྲའི་འཛེ་དའོས་རྫས་འརྡོ་ཡཡེ་ཕྲོས་ཏཡ། སྟོ་ཀཡི་ངའུས།། འཛོས་སྡའས། ཨ+་འརློས་ལཡེས་ནྭཡིས། ཀའུ་འཕྲའི་ཕྲོས་ངའུས། ལཡེས་ཛོ?་ལཡེས་རེས་ནཡོས་ཐའ་ཤེམ་ཏཡ། འཛེ་ཕྲོས་ངའུས།། ཀྭའི་ལཡེས་འརྩེས་ངའུས།། འརྩེས་ཏཡ་ཙ་ངའུས། ཙ་ཏཡ་ཡོུ་ངའུས། ཡོུ་ཏཡ་ཐའ་ངའུས།། ཐཡོས་ཏཡ་དའོས་ཕྲོས་ངའུས།། འརྩེས་ལཡེས་རྨའེས་སཡིས་ངའ་མཡེ། ལཡེས་དའེགས་མཡི་དཡུ། ལཡེས་ཡཡེ་ལཡེས་མཡེ། ཚོག་རྫས་ཕྲོས་ངའུས།། རྐྱི་རྨེས་ཐཡོས་སྦྲའེས་གཡིག་གྭཨེ་ཛུ་ཡུས།།

7 Rhyme inventory

7.1 Main cycle (R.1–R.60)

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.1	1.01 [illegible]	2.01 [illegible]	*-u̱*	ཨའུ
R.2	1.02 [illegible]	2.02 [illegible]	*-u*	ཨུ
R.3	1.03 [illegible]	2.03 [illegible]	*-u*	ཨཡུ
R.4	1.04 [illegible]	2.04 [illegible]	*-u̱*	ཨའུ
R.5	1.05 [illegible]	2.05 [illegible]	*n- -u̱*	འཨའུ
R.6	1.06 [illegible]		*n- -au̱*	འཨཨུ

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.7	1.07 [illegible]	2.06 [illegible]	*n- -u*	འཨུ
R.8	1.08 [illegible]	2.07 [illegible]	*-i̯*	ཨའི
R.9	1.09 [illegible]	2.08 [illegible]	*-ai̯*	ཨཨི
R.10	1.10 [illegible]	2.09 [illegible]	*-i*	ཨི
R.11	1.11 [illegible]	2.10 [illegible]	*-i*	ཨཡི
R.12	1.12 [illegible]	2.11 [illegible]	*n- -i̯*	འཨའི
R.13	1.13 [illegible]		*n- -ai̯*	འཨཨི
R.14	1.14 [illegible]	2.12 [illegible]	*n- -i*	འཨི
R.15	1.15 [illegible]	2.13 [illegible]	*-i̯ṃ*	ཨའིམ
R.16	1.16 [illegible]		*-iṃ*	ཨིམ
R.17	1.17 [illegible]	2.14 [illegible]	*-a̯*	ཨའ
R.18	1.18 [illegible]	2.15 [illegible]	*-aa̯*	ཨཨ
R.19	1.19 [illegible]	2.16 [illegible]	*-a*	ཨ
R.20	1.20 [illegible]	2.17 [illegible]	*-a*	ཨཡ
R.21	1.21 [illegible]	2.18 [illegible]	*-aw*	ཨག
R.22	1.22 [illegible]	2.19 [illegible]	*n- -a̯*	འཨའ
R.23		2.20 [illegible]	*n- -aa̯*	འཨཨ
R.24	1.23 [illegible]	2.21 [illegible]	*n- -a*	འཨ
R.25	1.24 [illegible]	2.22 [illegible]	*-a̯ṃ*	ཨའམ
R.26	1.25 [illegible]	2.23 [illegible]	*-aa̯ṃ*	ཨཨམ
R.27	1.26 [illegible]	2.24 [illegible]	*-aṃ*	ཨམ
R.28	1.27 [illegible]	2.25 [illegible]	*-ə̯*	ཨའེ
R.29	1.28 [illegible]	2.26 [illegible]	*-aə̯*	ཨཨེ
R.30	1.29 [illegible]	2.27 [illegible]	*-ə*	ཨེ
R.31	1.30 [illegible]	2.28 [illegible]	*-ə*	ཨཡེ
R.32	1.31 [illegible]		*n- -ə̯*	འཨའེ
R.33	1.32 [illegible]	2.29 [illegible]	*n- -ə*	འཨེ

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.34	1.33 [illegible]	2.30 [illegible]	*-e̱*	ཨའེ
R.35	1.34 [illegible]	2.31 [illegible]	*-ae̱*	ཨཨེ
R.36	1.35 [illegible]	2.32 [illegible]	*-e*	ཨེ
R.37	1.36 [illegible]	2.33 [illegible]	*-e*	ཨཡེ
R.38	1.37 [illegible]	2.34 [illegible]	*n- -e̱*	འཨའེ
R.39	1.38 [illegible]		*n- -ae̱*	འཨཨེ
R.40	1.39 [illegible]	2.35 [illegible]	*n- -e*	འཨེ
R.41	1.40 [illegible]		*-e̱ṃ*	ཨའེམ
R.42	1.41 [illegible]	2.36 [illegible]	*-ae̱ṃ*	ཨཨེམ
R.43	1.42 [illegible]	2.37 [illegible]	*-eṃ*	ཨེམ
R.44	1.43 [illegible]	2.38 [illegible]	*-i̱w*	ཨའིག
R.45	1.44 [illegible]	2.39 [illegible]	*-ai̱w*	ཨཨིག
R.46	1.45 [illegible]	2.40 [illegible]	*-iw*	ཨིག
R.47	1.46 [illegible]		*-iw*	ཨཡིག
R.48		2.41 [illegible]	*n- -i̱w*	འཨའིག
R.49	1.47 [illegible]		*n- -iw*	འཨིག
R.50	1.48 [illegible]		*-ow*	ཨོག
R.51	1.49 [illegible]	2.42 [illegible]	*-o̱*	ཨའོ
R.52	1.50 [illegible]	2.43 [illegible]	*-ao̱*	ཨཨོ
R.53	1.51 [illegible]	2.44 [illegible]	*-o*	ཨོ
R.54	1.52 [illegible]	2.45 [illegible]	*n- -o̱*	འཨའོ
R.55	1.53 [illegible]	2.46 [illegible]	*n- -ao̱, n- -o*	འཨཨོ, འཨོ
R.56	1.54 [illegible]	2.47 [illegible]	*-o̱ṃ*	ཨའོམ
R.57	1.55 [illegible]	2.48 [illegible]	*-ao̱ṃ, -oṃ*	ཨཨོམ, ཨོམ
R.58	1.56 [illegible]	2.49 [illegible]	*-oṃ*	ཨོམ
R.59	1.57 [illegible]		*-uo*	ཨོུ

R.60		2.50 [illegible]	*(-uo?)*	ཨོུ

7.2 First minor cycle (R.61–R.76?): tense vowels *-h*

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.61	1.58 [illegible]	2.51 [illegible]	*-ụh*	སྙའུ
R.62	1.59 [illegible]	2.52 [illegible]	*-aụh, -uh*	སྙཨུ, སྙུ
R.63	1.60 [illegible]	2.53 [illegible]	*-ẹh, -aẹh*	སྙའེ, སྙཨེ
R.64	1.61 [illegible]	2.54 [illegible]	*-eh*	སྙེ
R.65	1.62 [illegible]	2.55 [illegible]	*-eṃh*	སྙེམ
R.66	1.63 [illegible]	2.56 [illegible]	*-ạh*	སྙའ
R.67	1.64 [illegible]	2.57 [illegible]	*-aạh, -ah*	སྙཨ, སྙ
R.68	1.65 [illegible]	2.58 [illegible]	*-ịh*	སྙའི
R.69	1.66 [illegible]	2.59 [illegible]	*-aịh*	སྙཨི
R.70	1.67 [illegible]	2.60 [illegible]	*-ih*	སྙི
R.71	1.68 [illegible]		*-ə̣h*	སྙའྀ
R.72	1.69 [illegible]	2.61 [illegible]	*-aə̣h, -əh*	སྙཨྀ, སྙྀ
R.73	1.70 [illegible]	2.62 [illegible]	*-ọṃh*	སྙའོམ
R.74	1.71 [illegible]	2.63 [illegible]	*-ọh*	སྙའོ
R.75	1.72 [illegible]	2.64 [illegible]	*-oh*	སྙོ
R.76		2.65 [illegible]	*(-aẹṃh?)*	སྙཨེམ

7.3 Second minor cycle (R.77?–R.98): retroflex vowels *r-...-r*

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.77	1.73 [illegible]	2.66 [illegible]	*r- -ẹr*	ཨའེ

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.78		2.67 [illegible]	*r- -a̱er*	ཛཨེ
R.79	1.74 [illegible]	2.68 [illegible]	*r- -er*	ཛེ
R.80	1.75 [illegible]	2.69 [illegible]	*r- -u̱r*	ཛའུ
R.81	1.76 [illegible]	2.70 [illegible]	*r- -ur*	ཛུ
R.82	1.77 [illegible]	2.71 [illegible]	*r- -i̱r*	ཛའི
R.83	1.78 [illegible]		*r- -ai̱r*	ཛཨི
R.84	1.79 [illegible]	2.72 [illegible]	*r- -ir*	ཛི
R.85	1.80 [illegible]	2.73 [illegible]	*r- -a̱r*	ཛའ
R.86	1.81 [illegible]		*r- -aa̱r*	ཛཨ
R.87	1.82 [illegible]	2.74 [illegible]	*r- -ar*	ཛ
R.88	1.83 [illegible]		*n- -a̱r*	འཛའ
R.89		2.75 [illegible]	*r- -awr*	ཛག
R.90	1.84 [illegible]	2.76 [illegible]	*r- -ə̱r*	ཛའྀ
R.91	1.85 [illegible]		*r- -aə̱r*	ཛཨྀ
R.92	1.86 [illegible]	2.77 [illegible]	*r- -ər*	ཛྀ
R.93	1.87 [illegible]	2.78 [illegible]	*r- -i̱wr*	ཛའིག
R.94	1.88 [illegible]	2.79 [illegible]	*r- -iwr*	ཛིག
R.95	1.89 [illegible]	2.80 [illegible]	*r- -o̱r*	ཛའོ
R.96	1.90 [illegible]	2.81 [illegible]	*r- -ao̱r, r- -or*	ཛཨོ, ཛོ
R.97	1.91 [illegible]	2.82 [illegible]	*r- -o̱m̱r*	ཛའོམ
R.98		2.83 [illegible]	*(r- -om̱r?)*	ཛོམ

7.4 Miscellaneous categories (R.99–R.105)

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.99		2.84 [illegible]	*(n- -e̱r?)*	འཚའེ
R.100	1.92 [illegible]	2.85 [illegible]	*(r- -ər?)*	འཚི
R.101	1.93 [illegible]	2.86 [illegible]	*(r- -er?)*	འཚེ
R.102	1.94 [illegible]		*(r- -or?)*	ཚོ
R.103	1.95 [illegible]		*(r- -or?)*	ཚོ
R.104	1.96 [illegible]		*-ṳṃ*	ཨའུམ
R.105	1.97 [illegible]		*(r- -ar?)*	ཚ